

An opening filled, without chasing replies

“Making sure it moves to the next person without double-booking would matter most.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

The problem you described

Square shows the cancellation. The spreadsheet identifies possible clients. Manual texts leave you tracking replies instead of reaching the next suitable person.

Our proposal

Give one eligible client a clear offer and deadline. Let the system follow up automatically, while you and Carla keep control.

The business goal: fewer empty appointments and less staff checking, with no competing claims inside the offer process.

Why we chose one offer at a time

“But avoiding competing acceptances matters more; one at a time is safer if it keeps moving automatically.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

Alternative: text several clients

Benefit

Reach more people immediately.

Cost

Competing replies need a winner and an explanation to everyone else. Staff still reconcile the outcome.

The tradeoff we accepted

Certainty over maximum reach. Lena chose 15 minutes for same-day offers, with no new offer inside 15 minutes of the appointment.

Chosen: one exclusive offer

Benefit

One clear holder. Decline or timeout automatically advances the waitlist.

Cost

An unanswered offer holds the opening for up to 15 minutes before the next person gets a turn.

A suitable appointment before queue position

“Only contact people whose recorded availability covers the opening.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

Flexible matching

Could reach more people, but depends on unconfirmed availability or a stylist compromise.

Chosen matching rule

Same service. Availability covers the opening. Respect a required stylist. Then offer to the oldest eligible request.

The tradeoff

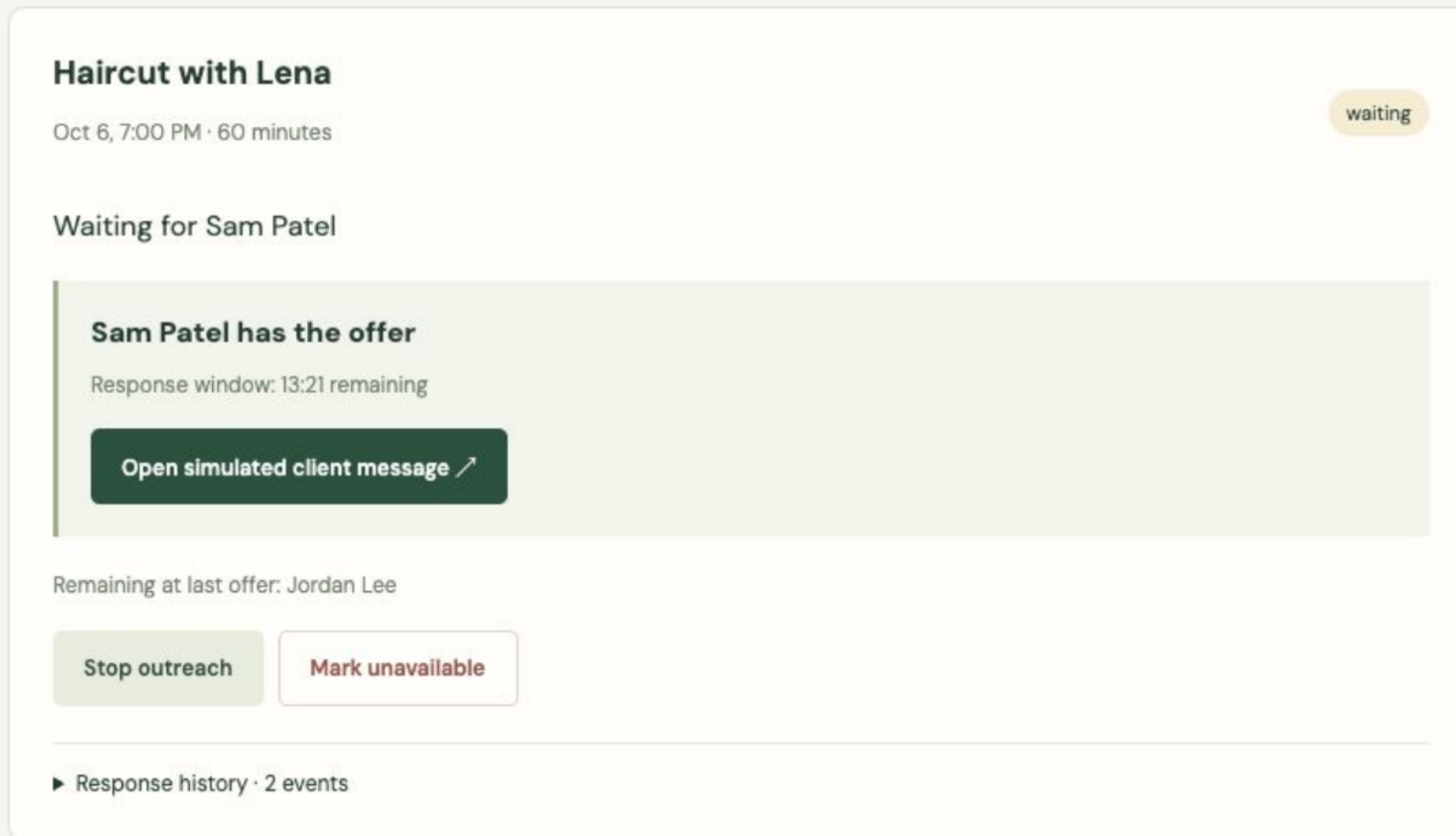
A smaller pool of clients, with fewer unsuitable offers. Staff can confirm flexibility before including someone.

Fairness continues after the offer

Declines and timeouts keep their place for future openings. Acceptance removes the request. Skip clients already considering another offer.

What you and your client actually see

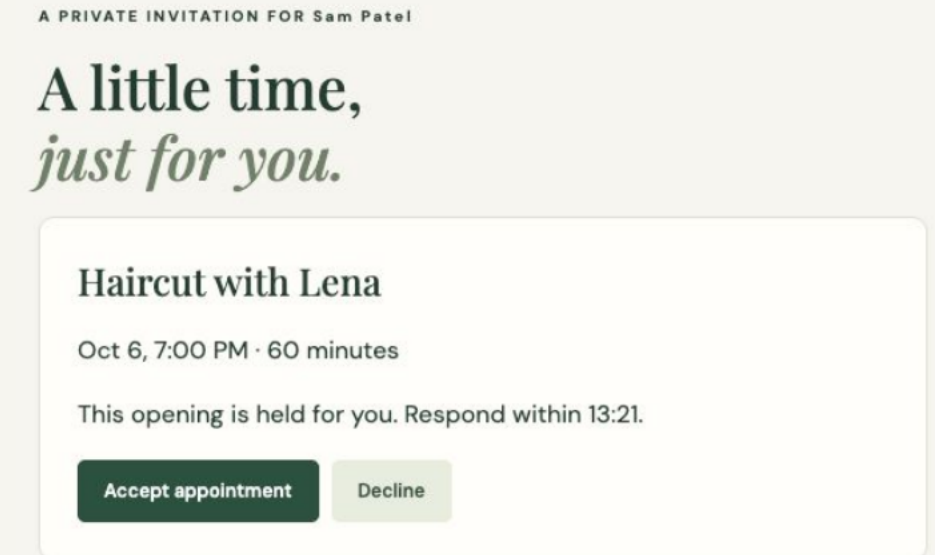
For staff: a held opening, countdown and stop controls



Actual local prototype. Fictional clients. Messages are simulated.

4 / 5 Proposal for Lena and Carla

For the client: a private invitation



Local prototype · This private screen simulates a text message. Square updates are handled by salon staff.

Temporal keeps the deadline and offer history durable. One workflow coordinates claims across openings and rejects expired or duplicate replies.

A clear handoff to Square, then a small pilot

“Yes, acceptance can mark it confirmed in the demo, while staff record it in Square.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

Confirmation: the choice

Staff approval adds a human check but keeps clients waiting. We chose immediate demo confirmation when the opening is still available.

The cost: staff still update Square and mark externally booked openings unavailable. This demo cannot prevent conflicts with unseen Square changes.

Prototype boundary: sample waitlist, simulated messages and optional 15-second demo timing. No live integrations or measured business results yet.

The next decision for you

Rehearse the flow with Carla, then agree a supervised pilot. Before real outreach, add SMS, authenticated access and a reliable Square availability check.

Measure filled openings, staff follow-up time and booking conflicts. Agree delivery-failure and busy-client retry rules before the pilot.